



Striped hyena

Also found in Asia as far as India, this nighttime hunter has teeth and jaws strong enough to crush bone.

Rabat

Algiers

MOROCCO

ATLAS MOUNTAINS

TUNISIA

Barbary sheep

This is Africa's only wild sheep. Males charge at each other with their heads down when fighting.

Just 4 in (10 cm) long, this lizard licks its eyes to clean them.

Dune gecko

This snake's "horns" are really special scales that protect its eyes from sand.

Desert horned viper

AHAGGAR MOUNTAINS

ALGERIA

ADRAR DES IFORAS

MALI

NIGER

WESTERN SAHARA

Desert monitor lizard

The desert monitor uses its long, powerful tail like a whip to defend itself.

Also called a "screw-horn antelope," the endangered addax has horns up to 47 in (120 cm) long.

Addax

Gigantic swarms of desert locusts can contain billions of insects and stretch for 40 miles (64 km).

Desert locust

Nouakchott

Niamey

Bamako

Abuja

SCALE

0 250 miles
0 250 kilometers

Sahara desert

The Sahara is the Earth's largest hot desert. It covers 3,630,000 sq miles (9,400,000 sq km) and is home to about 70 animal and 500 plant species. They have to deal with temperatures as high as 135°F (57°C) and very little rainfall.



Fennec fox

This small fox's huge ears aren't only great for hearing. They also help to keep the fox cool by releasing its body heat into the air.